

A

Location*

“We live **on the outskirts of town**¹, and it’s a very nice **location**. We used to live in the centre, but we **moved**² to our present flat when we had children because there’s more **space**³ for them to play and it has nice **views**⁴.”

* the place and position of something

¹ on the edge of town

² changed the place where we live

³ an area that is empty or not used

⁴ the things you can see from a place

B

Our flat

“This is where we live. We **rent**¹ a flat **on the second floor**. There’s a family in the flat **downstairs**², and a young French couple **upstairs**, on the top floor. It’s a modern **block of flats**³, and it’s quite good, although the **lift**⁴ is small, and there’s no **air conditioning**⁵.”

¹ pay money every week/month to use it because it isn’t ours

² on a lower level of a building

³ a building with a number of flats in it

⁴ the machine that takes people up or down a floor

⁵ a system that keeps the air cool

Language help

Flat is more common in British English; **apartment** is used in American English but is becoming more common in British English. Apartments are usually in large buildings; flats can be in a large building or part of a larger house.



C

A house in the country

“My parents **own**¹ a **cottage**². It’s a **charming**³ house and **has lots of character**⁴, but like many old buildings, it’s quite **dark** (*opp light*), quite difficult to **heat**⁵, and it doesn’t have **central heating**⁶.”

¹ they bought it

² a small house, that is old and attractive, and usually found in the country

³ pleasant and attractive

⁴ it is interesting and unusual

⁵ make warm or hot

⁶ a system that heats a whole house



cottage

Exercises

17.1 Are the sentences about the people on the opposite page true or false? If the sentence is false, change it to make it true.

- 1 They live in a house. *False. They live in a flat.*
- 2 They used to live on the outskirts of town.
- 3 They own their flat.
- 4 They've got nice views from their flat.
- 5 They live on the first floor.
- 6 There's a lift in the building.
- 7 A French couple live downstairs.
- 8 They own a cottage.
- 9 The cottage has lots of character.
- 10 The cottage is quite cold.

17.2 Are these generally positive or negative features of a home?

- | | | |
|-----------------------|------------------|--------------------|
| views <i>positive</i> | air conditioning | character |
| dark | charming | no central heating |

17.3 Label the pictures.



17.4 Complete the sentences.

- 1 Our flat doesn't have air *conditioning*.
- 2 I live _____ the second floor, and my cousin lives _____, on the first floor.
- 3 My old flat was very small, but this one has much more _____.
- 4 The flat's in a great _____: it's near the centre of town but opposite a park and very quiet.
- 5 We live on the _____ of town, but it's only a twenty-minute walk to the centre.
- 6 The flat is on the third floor, but we can sit outside on the _____.
- 7 It's a very big house, so it costs a lot of money to _____ in the winter.
- 8 I'm on the second _____. I usually use the stairs, but take the _____ if I'm feeling lazy.
- 9 I live in Paris. I used to live in Marseilles, but I _____ to Paris when I left university.
- 10 I love my apartment. It has big windows, so it's nice and _____ inside.

17.5 Over to you

Answer the questions about your home.

- | | |
|--|------------------------------------|
| 1 Do you live in a house or flat? | 5 How long have you lived there? |
| 2 If you live in a flat, what floor is it on? | 6 Do you have these things: |
| 3 Do you own your home or rent it? | air conditioning? central heating? |
| 4 Are you in the centre, or on the outskirts of your town? | a balcony? |